ing Indian management education.

The NEP's push toward autonomy and global alignment has especially energised the second-generation IIMs and the best private B-schools. International partnerships are multiplying. Dual-degree programmes are being explored. AI-integrated classrooms are becoming routine. And foreign universities, some ranked among the global top 500, are preparing to enter India, raising the competitive bar further.

But beneath the surface of institutional growth lies a discomforting truth: India does not have enough qualified management faculty to sustain the growth of its B-schools. Even top ones find it difficult to attract international faculty. Public institutions remain bound by rigid pay scales, while private schools are unable to compete with global academic salaries. In response, institutions are investing heavily in faculty development programmes, research incentives and international collaborations that upgrade academic quality.

## Looking forward

To understand what the 2025 survey really reveals, one must step back from the tables and see the landscape they sketch. Students today are not merely deciding where to study, they are deciding how they want to learn, what they hope to gain and why a particular pathway aligns with the life they imagine for themselves. The hunger that animated the Indian MBA boom of the 1990s remains unchanged. But the pathways to fulfil it have multiplied, fragmented and globalised. For B-schools, this survey proves that relevance, not reputation, is now the ultimate currency. The B-school that wins the next decade will be the school that understands this arithmetic of aspiration: flexible, interdisciplinary, digitally fluent and anchored in real-world value. ■

METHODOLOGY

# HOW THE B-SCHOOLS WERE RANKED

The 2025 India Today Group survey of the country's business schools was conducted by Delhi-based market research firm Marketing & Development Research Associates (MDRA). The survey provides the most credible and exhaustive rankings of India's Best B-schools based on the most recent data. This year's edition includes dedicated lists for Top Executive Programmes, Top Advanced Management Programmes (for professionals with over 10 years of experience), Top Executive Fellow Programmes in Management, top on-campus Fellow Programmes in Management, and the top online MBAs in India.

B-schools, offering full-time classroom management programmes (PGDM/MBA), established at least five years ago and with a minimum of three graduated batches till academic year ending 2024, were considered for the full-time MBA/PGDM rankings. An objective questionnaire was finetuned to obtain the latest relevant information (current year data) from the institutes on 127 attributes to give stakeholders more realistic, updated and accurate information. Of the 2,500-plus B-schools across India who qualified for participation, 275 responded within the deadline, and 271 eligible ones were ranked.

After receiving the objective data, four processes—data cleaning logical checks, validation, back-checks and audits—were conducted. In the first stage, every aspect of the details provided was carefully examined through available information and database available with MDRA. In the second stage, verification and audits were conducted by MDRA researchers to ensure accuracy of the data submitted. The five key parameters of evaluation were Learning Experience, Living Experience, Selection Process, Placement Performance and Future Orientation. The final rank was assigned based on objective data after various levels of cross-validation and physical audits.

A large team comprising researchers, statisticians, econometricians and analysts worked on this project from April to October 2025. The MDRA core team, led by Abhishek Agrawal (executive director), comprised Abnish Jha (senior project director), Vaibhav Gupta, Manveer Singh, Robin Singh and Rishav Sharma.

*Note: For the detailed methodology on all courses, please visit www.indiatoday.in*